

# Proposal: Analyzing AI in Healthcare Through Slack and Wise's Lens of Progress

Article:

*"Artificial Intelligence in Health Care: Opportunities, Challenges, and Ethical Considerations"*

Published in the *North Carolina Medical Journal*, July 2024.

<https://ncmedicaljournal.com/article/120561>

Lens:

Slack and Wise's critique of common societal uses of "progress"

Thesis Statement:

The article *"Artificial Intelligence in Health Care: Opportunities, Challenges, and Ethical Considerations"* presents AI as a revolutionary tool in healthcare, emphasizing its benefits in diagnostics, predictive analytics, and personalized treatment. However, when examined through Slack and Wise's critique of progress, this perspective reveals an unchecked optimism that overlooks ethical dilemmas, systemic biases, and unintended societal consequences. Slack and Wise argue that technological progress should not be measured solely by efficiency and innovation but by its broader impact on society. Their framework provides a critical lens to reassess the claims made in the article, highlighting the need for ethical scrutiny in AI's implementation within healthcare.

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## Outline

### I. Introduction

- Overview of AI's role in healthcare, including advancements in diagnostics, predictive analytics, and personalized treatment.
  - Introduction of the article *"Artificial Intelligence in Health Care: Opportunities, Challenges, and Ethical Considerations"*, which discusses the benefits and challenges of AI in medicine.
  - Thesis Statement: The article presents AI as a revolutionary tool in healthcare, focusing on efficiency and accuracy. However, when analyzed through Slack and Wise's critique of progress, this perspective reveals an unchecked optimism that overlooks ethical dilemmas, systemic biases, and unintended societal consequences. Slack and Wise emphasize that technological progress should be critically evaluated beyond its immediate benefits, highlighting the need for ethical scrutiny in AI's implementation.
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### II. Summary of the Article

- AI's Benefits in Healthcare:
    - AI enhances diagnostic accuracy, particularly in medical imaging, detecting diseases like cancer with higher precision.
    - Predictive analytics help identify patient deterioration earlier, improving treatment outcomes.
    - Personalized medicine allows for more targeted and effective therapies based on genetic data.
    - Operational efficiency increases through automation, reducing administrative burdens and streamlining hospital workflows.
  - Challenges and Risks Acknowledged in the Article:
    - Ethical concerns regarding data privacy and patient consent.
    - The risk of algorithmic bias in AI models leading to healthcare disparities.
    - The potential for job displacement due to automation in medical settings.
  - Despite acknowledging these issues, the article maintains an overwhelmingly positive tone, presenting AI as an inevitable and beneficial technological advancement.
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### III. Slack and Wise's Lens on Progress

- Technological Progress is Not Always Beneficial:
    - Slack and Wise argue that society often equates technological advancements with progress, overlooking potential negative consequences.
  - Unintended Consequences Must Be Considered:
    - New technologies frequently introduce ethical, social, and economic issues that are ignored in the rush toward adoption.
  - Progress Should Be Evaluated Critically, Not Assumed as Good:
    - The perception of progress should be based on qualitative assessments, considering its impact on various social groups.
  - Application to AI in Healthcare:
    - AI adoption in medicine must be scrutinized beyond efficiency gains to avoid exacerbating healthcare inequalities.
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### IV. Applying Slack and Wise's Lens to the Article

#### 1. The Assumption That AI is Inherently Progressive

- The article assumes AI-driven healthcare advancements represent positive progress, with little critique of its broader implications.
- Slack and Wise challenge this assumption, arguing that new technologies must be evaluated for their societal impact rather than assumed beneficial.
- Example: AI improves diagnostic accuracy but also risks reinforcing biases in medical datasets, disproportionately affecting underrepresented communities.

## 2. Ethical and Bias Concerns Overlooked in the Article

- The article acknowledges algorithmic bias but does not fully explore its potential consequences.
- Slack and Wise's perspective:
  - AI models trained on incomplete or biased datasets can lead to misdiagnoses, worsening healthcare disparities for marginalized groups.
  - This contradicts the assumption that AI is universally beneficial, as its implementation could inadvertently harm vulnerable populations.

## 3. The Need for a More Nuanced Evaluation of AI

- The article highlights AI's role in increasing efficiency, but Slack and Wise warn against prioritizing efficiency over ethical considerations.
  - Example: AI-driven automation may reduce hospital costs but could also displace human healthcare workers, raising concerns about employment security.
  - Slack and Wise's argument: True progress involves responsible implementation, integrating safeguards to address ethical risks before widespread adoption.
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## V. Conclusion

- Restate thesis statement: The article portrays AI in healthcare as an inevitable and beneficial progression. However, through Slack and Wise's critique, this narrative appears overly optimistic, neglecting the ethical and societal complexities of AI integration.
  - Final Argument:
    - AI's role in healthcare should be evaluated critically rather than embraced unconditionally.
    - Ethical oversight, transparency, and inclusivity must shape AI's development to ensure true progress, as defined by Slack and Wise.
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## Conclusion

This proposal outlines a critical analysis of *"Artificial Intelligence in Health Care: Opportunities, Challenges, and Ethical Considerations"* using Slack and Wise's framework on technological progress. By examining how the article portrays AI in healthcare, this paper will highlight the risks of assuming technology equates to progress without fully considering its ethical and societal impacts. Through this analysis, the goal is to demonstrate that AI in healthcare should not be blindly adopted but instead subjected to a more rigorous and cautious evaluation to ensure it serves all of society equitably.